

IDS11074
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia Gulf Waters

Issued at 3:30 pm CST on Thursday 6 August 2026
for the period until midnight CST Sunday 9 August 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A weak high pressure system centred over NSW will slowly move east while maintaining a ridge over SA until Saturday. A strong cold front will then begin to move into the Bight and move east over the state from late Saturday and throughout Sunday. Another cold front is then forecast to move into the Bight from late Monday.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Thursday 6 August until midnight

Winds: Variable below 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Friday 7 August

Winds: North to northeasterly below 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots before dawn. Winds reaching up to 20 knots south of Cowell to Wallaroo during the day. Seas: Below 0.5 metres, increasing to around 1 metre during the morning. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers.

Forecast for Saturday 8 August

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Sunday 9 August

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning westerly 20 to 30 knots during the morning. Seas: 1 to 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the afternoon. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Cloudy. Near 100% chance of rain. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Thursday 6 August until midnight

Winds: Variable below 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 7 August

Winds: Northerly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers.

Forecast for Saturday 8 August

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly 15 to 20 knots before dawn. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Port Vincent to Brighton during the morning. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers.

Forecast for Sunday 9 August

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots turning westerly 20 to 30 knots during the day. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2.5 metres during the afternoon. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Cloudy. Near 100% chance of rain. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 6 August until midnight

Winds: Variable below 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Friday 7 August

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly 15 to 20 knots early in the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers.

Forecast for Saturday 8 August

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm at night.

Forecast for Sunday 9 August

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots shifting southwesterly 25 to 30 knots during the morning. Seas: 1 to 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 5 metres during the afternoon or evening. Weather: Cloudy. Near 100% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Thursday 6 August until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 7 August

Winds: Northeasterly below 10 knots tending northerly 15 to 20 knots before dawn. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1 to 2 metres during the morning, then decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres by early evening. Weather: Partly cloudy. 95% chance of showers.

Forecast for Saturday 8 August

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northerly 15 to 20 knots before dawn. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre by early evening. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Sunday 9 August

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 25 knots turning west to southwesterly 20 to 30 knots during the morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 2 to 2.5 metres during the afternoon. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1 to 2 metres during the evening. Weather: Cloudy. Near 100% chance of rain. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 pm CST Thursday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.